

ESDU Portfolio

25 Years of Sustainable Development

Environment and Sustainable Development Unit
American University of Beirut

February 4, 2026

Mission, Vision, Core Values

Mission

Our mission is to harness education, research, and development to advance sustainable and resilient food systems against global challenges.

Vision

Our vision is for a world where communities and ecosystems thrive together, achieving food security, environmental sustainability, and social equity.

Core Values

- Keepers of The Land: Stewards of the Heritage
- Local Roots, Global Wings: Community Centered, Global Player
- Exploring Solutions Defying Uncertainties: Innovation for Sustainable Futures
- Participation & Inclusion
- Evidence & Integrity
- Embedding development into relief
- People at the Center
- AI at the service of heritage

ESDU at Work

Explore how ESDU translates research into impactful solutions.

Bridging Research and Practice

Translating applied research into tangible community solutions that advance sustainability and resilience.

Developing Skills

Building capacities through CEC courses, school programs, and the KariaNet platform to strengthen skills and opportunities.

Community Support

Supporting thousands of small actors through skills development, livelihood enhancement, and market linkages.

Building Partnerships

Collaborating with major partners, research centers, and donors to scale impact across the MENA and Mediterranean regions.

Disseminating Knowledge

Producing evidence and sharing lessons through conferences, publications, and regional networks and communities of practice.

Showcasing Solutions

Demonstrating real-world impact through flagship programs and living examples of sustainable transformation.

Strategic Goals 2025–2030

Five interconnected pillars guiding ESDU's next chapter.

Innovative ESDU

Advancing circular economy, AI, sustainable design, food systems, and heritage through cutting-edge research and innovation.

Bright ESDU

Driving education for sustainable food systems through online platforms, school programs, and Continuing Education Center (CEC) courses, expanding scholarships and regional student outreach.

Engaged ESDU

Fostering community action, strategic partnerships, and network-based approaches for transformative change.

Smart ESDU

Empowering AI and digital literacy, innovation, and global collaboration for a smarter sustainable future.

Sustainable ESDU

Ensuring institutional resilience through team growth, creative fundraising, and strong partnerships.

Keepers of the Land

A Keeper of the Land is anyone dedicated to preserving and protecting our heritage, agriculture, and natural resources for future generations. ESDU's flagship initiative connects small producers to markets, supports land stewards with resources and recognition, and sustains rural livelihoods through the Keepers of the Land Research Fund launched in 2015.

People at the Center • Embedding Research into Development • Embedding Relief into Community Systems • Education for Sustainable Futures

[Explore the Initiative Online →](#)

Key Topics

Food Security • Rural Development • Agroecology • Social Protection • Value Chains • Climate Smart Agriculture • Circular Economy • Women Empowerment

Impact & Outreach

Numbers that reflect community-led growth and recognition.

15 Million USD Amount of Funding	70 Number of Grants
100,000 Livelihoods Strengthened (beneficiaries)	12,000 Women as Keepers of the Land
170 Publications	110 Education & Research Integration (students & researchers)
20,000 Capacity Building & Training (trainees)	400 Engagement & Community Reach (entities)
60 Partnerships & Power of Attraction	12 Recognition & Awards
350 Employment & Institutional Growth (individuals)	

Geographical Outreach

ESDU's work spans local, regional, and global scales - from Lebanese communities to international partnerships across multiple continents.

Partners and Donors

Enduring partnerships across the globe.

[International Development Research Centre \(IDRC\)](#)

[U.S. Agency for International Development \(USAID\)](#)

[Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations \(FAO\)](#)

[International Fund for Agricultural Development \(IFAD\)](#)

[United Nations Development Programme \(UNDP\)](#)

[The World Food Programme \(WFP\)](#)

[European Commission](#)

[Near East Foundation \(NEF\)](#)

[Bureau of Population, Refugees, and Migration \(BPRM\)](#)

[Concern Worldwide \(CWW\)](#)

[Arab Fund for Economic and Social Development \(AFESD\)](#)

[Khalifa International Award for Innovation in Date Palm and Agricultural Development](#)

[Partnership for Research and Innovation in the Mediterranean Area \(PRIMA\)](#)

[DROSOS Foundation](#)

[Porticus Foundation](#)

Projects

Explore our diverse portfolio of initiatives driving sustainable development.

[Mediterranean Waste Innovations for Sustainable Environments \(MEDWISE\)](#)

[Sustainable Integrated Municipal Actions \(SiMA\)](#)

[Small Green Innovative Projects - Lebanon](#)

[CLIMAT 2: Climate and Livestock: Mainstreaming Appropriate Technologies](#)

[CLIMAT: Climate-Smart Livelihoods Initiatives and Market Access Tailoring](#)

[ISNAD Project](#)

[Med4Waste](#)

[MedSNAIL](#)

[REEF](#)

[ECO](#)

[Women's Economic Participation](#)

[Promoting a Healthier Environment Through Youth Engagement in Solid Waste Management](#)

[RELEAF Project](#)

[Value Chains for Improved Socioeconomic Well-being of Syrian Refugees and Lebanese Host Communities](#)

[Reducing the Direct Economic Downturn Impact on Vulnerable Communities in Lebanon - Beirut & Tripoli](#)

[Reducing the Direct Economic Downturn Impact on Vulnerable Communities in Lebanon - Bekaa & South of Lebanon](#)

[CORUSUS](#)

[SURFOLY](#)

[RESOLVE](#)

Note: All project names are clickable links in PDF viewers that support hyperlinks.

Environment and Sustainable Development Unit (ESDU)

American University of Beirut

© 2026 ESDU. All rights reserved.